

Once your image is open in the File menu, click on Save As. Choose the directory you want to save it in, and the extension it will have. By default, the “save as” type will be the same as that of the original image if you haven’t made changes to it such as adding layers or masks. Select the JPEG type if it’s not already selected by default, and click Save.



The JPEG saving options in Photoshop

Now a JPEG options box will pop up, giving you a quality vs. file size setting. You can move the slider to the left (smaller file size) to choose a lower quality. Alternatively, you can enter a numeric value between 1 and 12. The file size corresponding to any particular setting is displayed at the bottom of the box.

The *Format Options* allows you three choices—Baseline (standard), Baseline (optimized) and Progressive. Baseline Optimized can reduce file sizes better than Standard, but certain image reading software and browsers were not compatible with this—hence the option. However, for your purposes of sharing images today, you can safely choose Baseline Optimized.

Now, we come to Progressive JPEG: have you observed certain images on the Web appearing initially blurred and then gradually getting clearer in three to five passes? The details appear *progressively*—hence the name. If you are not saving the image for the Web, you can ignore this option.

The extent to which you can reduce the file size of your images is something you have to decide based on the quality that’s acceptable to you for your purposes. The distortion that the quality loss